



Center for Executive Succession
UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH CAROLINA

Introduction

DARLA MOORE SCHOOL OF BUSINESS



HR@Moore Survey of Chief Human Resource Officers

Welcome to the 2024 HR@Moore Survey of Chief Human Resource Officers.

This survey is conducted by the Center of Executive Succession in the Darla Moore School of Business at the University of South Carolina. It has been led by Patrick Wright working in conjunction with the following CHROs:

2024 HR@Moore CHRO Survey Advisory Board

Tim Richmond - *Current Chair*
AbbVie

Anita Graham
Labcorp

Carol Surface
Apple, Inc.

Christine Pambianchi - *Incoming Chair*
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The Home Depot

Senior Strategic Advisors

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Suffolk Construction (Retired)

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Prudential Financial, Inc.

Pam Kimmet
Manulife

Ken Carrig
SunTrust Bank (Retired)

Melissa Anderson
Albemarle Corporation

Nickle LaMoreaux
IBM

Jim Duffy
CIT Group, Inc. (Retired)

Sheri Bronstein
Bank of America

Ernest Marshall
Eaton

Rich Floersch
McDonald’s (Retired)

Kevin Cox
LKC Advisory

Tim Massa
The Kroger Company

Mirian Graddick-Weir
Merck & Co. (Retired)

Mike D’Ambrose
The Boeing Company

Tom Plath
International Paper

Perry Stuckey
Eastman Chemical (Retired)

Darrell Ford
UPS

Ola Snow
Cardinal Health

Cynthia Trudell
PepsiCo, Inc. (Retired)

Instructions

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The purpose of this survey is to explore the CHRO role and understand how CHROs address their organization’s challenges. Our hope is to provide CHROs with data regarding key leverage points which will increase their effectiveness, particularly regarding interfaces with the Board of Directors.

This year we focus on preparing potential CHRO successors, talent movement and how firms plan on maintaining a unified culture in a time of political division.

All answers are confidential and are seen only by the researchers administering the survey. -No data will be released that is not aggregated across all of the respondents. – Quotes from open-ended questions will never be attributed to individuals. -Any potentially identifying information will be stripped before use.

Please answer the questions to the best of your ability. However, to save time, please feel free to skip any questions where you do not feel you have any particular insights or are not comfortable answering. On the open-ended questions, should you choose to answer, we request that you provide enough detail to ensure that we know what you mean. For example, instead of “identifying talent” you might be more specific and say “identifying the right executive level talent”, or “making sure we have enough bench strength among our executive team”.

If you have any questions, please contact: Patrick Wright at Patrick.wright@moore.sc.edu.

Demographics

Demographics

1. Sex

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female

2. Race

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino
- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

	Most Unprepared	Unprepared	Somewhat unprepared	Neither unprepared nor prepared	Somewhat prepared	Prepared	Most prepared
Creator of Talent Strategy: (Staffing critical roles, designing talent management processes, directing strategic workforce planning)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enterprise Change Leader: (Challenging the status quo, planning/ implementing enterprise change, managing stakeholders and advocating for employees)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Driver of Culture and Purpose: (Linking purpose to culture, measuring/ communicating the culture, holding leaders accountable for culture promise)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Trusted Advisor and Coach:(Advising/ coaching the CEO, maximizing ELT effectiveness, coach/ develop key enterprise talent)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

CHRO Succession

CHRO Succession

8. In terms of competencies, knowledge, skills, abilities, or other characteristics, what 3 things do you think differentiates a GREAT CHRO from a GOOD CHRO (specific KSAO's, NOT the Gartner model)?

9. When you were hired as CHRO, what was the CEO looking for that the previous CHRO did not have?

10. As you look at your current HR organization, how many of your direct reports do you consider a POTENTIAL successor to you in the next 0-3 years?

11. As you think about the things you can do to best develop an internal successor, what do you think will have the greatest impact to prepare them for the role (e.g. exposure to board, cross-functional roles)?

12. How likely do you believe that your successor will be internal from the HR organization?

- ☐ Extremely Unlikely
- ☐ Unlikely
- ☐ Somewhat unlikely
- ☐ Neither likely nor unlikely
- ☐ Somewhat likely
- ☐ Likely
- ☐ Extremely Likely

13. If you are successful in developing one or more qualified internal successors, what might cause the CEO to still decide to bring in an external successor?

14. How did the following executives and you (CHRO) come into the role?

CEO	Internal		Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
	☐		☐	☐
CFO	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
	☐	☐	☐	☐
CHRO	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire
	☐	☐	☐	☐
General Counsel	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)	Direct external hire



15. In your answer to the above question, why were you hired in this way?

BUSINESS LEADERS/TALENT ADAPTING TO SCALE

BUSINESS LEADERS/TALENT ADAPTING TO SCALE

16. Our past research has shown that the greatest cause of failure among internal executives who are promoted is their inability to “scale up,” i.e., manage a larger scale and more complex organization or set of responsibilities. As you think about promoting internal executives to the C-Suite or one level down, have you found any effective ways to DEVELOP them to be able to handle the larger scale and complexity before promoting, and if so, how?

17. Have you found any effective ways to ASSESS their ability to handle the larger scale and complexity before promoting them, and if so what are they?

18. Have you found any ways to help them ADAPT to the larger scale and complexity once they are promoted, and if so, what are they?

19. How important do you think each of the following are in determining the success of an executive who takes on a larger and more complex assignment?

	Extremely Unimportant	Unimportant	Somewhat unimportant	Neither unimportant nor important	Somewhat important	Important	Extremely important
Building trusted relationships	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Managing politics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Curiosity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Executive presence	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Ability to take enterprise-wide perspective	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal organization and prioritization	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Building and managing the team	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Translating company strategy to organizational capability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other (please specify)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Talent Movement

Talent Movement

20. In your talent planning processes how much weight do you place on each of the following when deciding on where to place talent across business units?

- ☐ Needs of the individual (development opportunities): 100%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 90%: Needs of the business, 10%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 80%: Needs of the business, 20%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 70%: Needs of the business: 30%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 60%: Needs of the business: 40%
- ☐ Needs of the individual 50%: Needs of the business, 50%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 40%: Needs of the business, 60%
- ☐ Needs of the individual, 30%: Needs of the business: 70%

- ☐ Needs of the **individual, 20%**: Needs of the **business, 80%**
- ☐ Needs of the **individual, 10%**: Needs of the **business, 90%**
- ☐ **Needs of the business: 100%**

21. When key positions are open, to what extent do each of the following work against you being able to easily move talent?

	Not at all (1)	2	3	Somewhat (4)	5	6	To a Great Extent (7)
Siloed nature of businesses	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No clear governance as to who (corporate v. business) owns talent	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Replaceability of the talent in the origin business	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Resistance of origin business leader to let talent go	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Resistance of destination business leader to take on unknown talent	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Resistance of the individual because of perceived risk of moving	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Resistance of the individual to move geographically	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other (please specify)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

22. To what extent is your **financial planning** aligned with your **talent/human capital allocation planning** (e.g. done concurrently with your talent/human capital planning)?

- ☐ Completely Unaligned
- ☐ Unaligned
- ☐ Somewhat unaligned
- ☐ Neither unaligned nor aligned
- ☐ Somewhat aligned
- ☐ Aligned
- ☐ Completely Aligned

- ☐ Both are specifically mentioned in these discussions
- ☐ Financial allocations are discussed but corresponding talent/human capital allocations are assumed by everyone who is part of the discussion (i.e., the financial capital will be used to grow headcount)
- ☐ Financial allocations are discussed and most people are either unaware or uninterested in the corresponding talent/human capital allocations

Managing Political Discussions

[illegible]

	No Threat (1)	2	3	Minor Threat (4)	5	6	Major Threat (7)
Other (please specify) 	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

25. To what extent is your ELT having discussions about how these issues might impact/threaten your culture?

- ☐ Not at all (1)
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ Somewhat (4)
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ Great Extent (7)

26. To what extent is your board having discussions about how these issues might impact/threaten your culture?

- ☐ Not at all (1)
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ Somewhat (4)
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ Great Extent (7)

27. Which of those do you worry most about and what are you currently doing to try to neutralize that threat to your culture?

28. To what extent do you use each of the following as a way to manage discussions about political/geopolitical issues in the workplace?

[illegible]

29. To what extent to each of the following describe how conflict **in general**, is managed within your company's culture (not specific to the sociopolitical or geopolitical issues described above)?

[illegible]

	Not at all (1)	2	3	Somewhat (4)	5	6	Great Extent (7)
In our company, employees are encouraged to fight for what they believe personally.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

CEO Succession

CEO Succession

30. What percentage of your external board members would you describe as being “highly interested” on CEO succession as opposed to mostly just going through the motions.

31. As far as the board is concerned, what do you think the majority believe about the timing of CEO succession?

- ☐ A CEO succession event **will definitely** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen within the next 2 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **will likely** happen in the next 2-5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **might** happen in the next 2-5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event **probably won’t** happen until after 5 years
- ☐ A CEO succession event is **definitely won’t** happen until after 5 years

32. To what degree would you agree with the following statements regarding CEO succession?

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
The CEO is regularly engaged and active with regard to CEO succession planning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The CEO actively makes CEO succession planning a priority	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not a current activity the board performs	Extremely ineffective	Worse than average	Average	Better than average	Extremely effective
Identifying internal leaders with CEO potential	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Analyzing the external marketplace for executives with leadership potential	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Assessing the capabilities of internal talent	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Providing opportunities for board member interactions with candidates	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating and ranking candidates based on the role profile	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Developing talent management scenarios based on succession selection scenarios	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Building diversity in the executive succession candidate pool	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Providing opportunities to for candidates to develop necessary skills	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Creating new opportunities and roles in the organization for candidates to grow	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Identifying outside opportunities for candidates to improve	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Providing personalized coaching and mentoring for candidates	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Providing developmental opportunities to improve candidate pool diversity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Developing appropriate plans for transition of incoming executives	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Developing appropriate plans for transitioning outgoing executives	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Notifying candidates of their status in the executive succession pool	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

